

NILO PEDRAZZINI

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Skills

Areas of specialization	Multilingual language modelling; language typology; semantics and discourse coherence; computational linguistics; Slavic linguistics. Corpus building and linguistic annotation (low-resource languages and noisy data).
Programming languages	Advanced Python, R and Bash. Intermediate Ruby.
My go-to NLP stack	MacOS, Jupyter (<i>local proof-of-concept</i>) · Ubuntu Azure VMs/HPC, Azure Blob Storage, Bash/SLURM (<i>cloud development</i>) · Pandas, BeautifulSoup (<i>data wrangling</i>) · spaCy, NLTK (<i>preprocessing</i>) · Transformers, PyTorch (& Lightning), Gensim (<i>language modeling</i>) · SciPy, PyKrig, gstat (R) (<i>interpolation</i>) · scikit-learn (<i>clustering, dimensionality reduction</i>) · Matplotlib/Seaborn, Plotly/Dash, Kepler (<i>visualization</i>) · MyBinder (<i>short-term dissemination</i>) · HuggingFace (<i>language model release</i>) · Weights & Biases (<i>experiment tracking</i>).
Natural languages	Italian (native), English (C2), Russian (C1), Spanish (Dele B2), Serbian (B1-B2), German (Goethe-Zertifikat B1). Good reading knowledge of Bulgarian, French, and Norwegian (Bokmål). Working knowledge of Ancient Greek, Hittite, Latin, Old Church Slavonic, Arabic (Egyptian), Huichol (Wixárika), Amele, and te reo Māori.

Academic Employment

Aug 2025–	Guest Researcher , University of Oslo, Dept. of Linguistics and Scandinavian Studies.
Aug 2023–	Turing Research Fellow , The Alan Turing Institute (London). 🎧
Aug 2024–Aug 2025	Research Engineering Fellow , The Alan Turing Institute (London).
Feb 2023–Jul 2023	Research Software Engineer , University of Oxford (<i>Digital Scholarship @ Oxford</i>) 🎧
Jan 2022–Jul 2023	Research Associate in Corpus-Based Digital Humanities , The Alan Turing Institute (London) (<i>Living with Machines</i>) 🎧👥
Sep 2021–Mar 2022	Hourly-Paid Lecturer in Digital Humanities, King's College London (Department of Digital Humanities).
Sep 2020–Jun 2021	Tutor in General Linguistics, Oriel College & Lady Margaret Hall, University of Oxford.
Dec 2020–Aug 2021	Research Assistant , Oxford School of Global and Area Studies, International Multimodal Communication Centre (IMCC) (<i>Depictions of Post-COVID-19 Futures in Russian International Media: Multimodal Viewpoint Analysis</i>) 🎧.
Feb–Jun 2020	Research Assistant , Department of Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford (<i>ReadOxford</i>) 🎧

Education

2023	DPhil in Linguistics , University of Oxford. Thesis: <i>A quantitative and typological study of Early Slavic participle clauses and their competition</i> . ESRC full scholarship (Grand Union DTP). Supervisor: Hanne M. Eckhoff.
Autumn 2020	Visiting PhD student , University of Oslo, Dept. of Linguistics and Scandinavian Studies. Supervisor: Dag T. T. Haug.
2019	MSt in Slavonic Studies (Serbian) , University of Oxford (<i>Distinction</i>). Bosnian-Croatian-Serbian language; history of Church Slavonic; Cyrillic palaeography. Supervisor: Hanne M. Eckhoff.

- 2015 – 2017 **MPhil in Theoretical and Applied Linguistics** (70% complete), Università di Pavia (29.2/30).
Thesis project: *Secondary uses of the Russian second-genitive*. Supervisor: Prof. Silvia Luraghi.
Exams: first-order logic, computational linguistics, advanced phonology, language typology, Celtic linguistics, Hittite language, advanced Russian, Slavic philology.
- 2015 **BA in Russian and English**, Università di Pavia (110/110 *Summa cum Laude*).
Thesis: *Old Believers' syllabic poetry and the Russian Baroque: Anonymous lamentations from the first half of the 18th century*. Supervisor: Maria C. Bragone.

Grants and Awards

- 2024 Publications 2022 Best Paper Award 
- 2019–2023 ESRC Grand Union DTP PhD Studentship for *Delimiting native and foreign syntax in Early Slavonic by enhancing digital corpora* (UKRI Proj. Ref.: 2266900) (~£90,000) 
- 2022 Circle U. Prize Award (PI: Barbara McGillivray), as a contributor to the project *The Language of Mechanization*, part of the *Living with Machines* project (The Alan Turing Institute), for 'innovative and novel approaches to inter- and trans-disciplinary research' 
- 2020 ESRC Overseas Institutional Visit Award, for a two-month visiting research period at the University of Oslo, Norway (~£4,000)
- 2019 Somerville College Archibald Jackson Prize (for achieving distinction at a graduate degree at Oxford)

Teaching

- Autumn 2024 (Workshop) *Data/Culture: Working with big historical data from maps and newspapers* (London).
- Spring 2024 (Workshop) *Data/Culture: Working with big historical data from maps and newspapers* (Lancaster).
- Autumn 2023 (Lectures) *Introduction to Text Mining with Python* (MSc in Digital Scholarship, University of Oxford).
- Summer 2023 (Summer School) *Applied Data Analysis*, Digital Humanities at Oxford Summer School (DHOxSS).
- Spring 2023 (Workshop) *AI and Historical Newspapers* (British Library).
- 2021 (Lectures) *The Cultural Web: Building a Humanities Website*. (King's College London).
- Spring 2021 (Tutorials) *Historical Linguistics* (University of Oxford).
- Winter 2021 (Tutorials) *Semantics & Pragmatics* (University of Oxford).
- (Tutorials) *Sociolinguistics* (University of Oxford).
- Autumn 2020 (Tutorials) *General Linguistics Foundations* (University of Oxford).
- (Tutorials) *Psycholinguistics* (University of Oxford).

Service

- **Editorial:** *Journal of Open Humanities Data*: Editorial Assistant (2021–2023), Section Editor (2022), Copyeditor (2020–2021)
- **Fellow*/Organizer†/Programme Committee‡/Reviewer:** Reproducibility Research Oxford (UK Reproducibility Network)* (2021–2025); Open Humanities Seminar Series (OHSS)† (2022); DH Benelux‡ (2022, 2024, 2025, 2026); AmericasNLP‡ (2026); ADHO Digital Humanities Conference; International Conference on Natural Language Processing for Digital Humanities (NLP4DH); Journal of Greek Linguistics; Axioms; Open Research Europe; Languages.
- **Supervision:** *Doctoral*: Miriam Eisenbruch (Oxford; co-supervision, 2024-); *Master's*: Malithi Alahapperuma (MSc, UCL/Turing; placement supervision, 2021).
- **Departmental service:** *Undergraduate admissions*: Lady Margaret Hall, University of Oxford for Modern Languages & Linguistics and Psychology and Philosophy & Linguistics (2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023).

Publications

Chapters in books

- 1 McGillivray, Barbara, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Arianna Ciula, Jon Lawrence, Tiffany Ong, Mia Ridge, and Miguel Vieira (Forthcoming). “Analysing the language of mechanisation in 19th-century British newspapers”. In: *Living with Machines: Computational Histories of the Age of Industry*. Ed. by Ruth Ahnert, Emma Griffin, Jon Lawrence, and the Living with Machines Team. London: University of London Press.
- 2 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** (Forthcoming). “Early Slavic When-clauses in cross-linguistic perspective”. In: *On the Diachrony of Adverbial Clauses* (Brill’s Studies in Historical Linguistics). Ed. by Łukasz Jędrzejowski. Leiden-Boston: Brill.
- 3 Marongiu, Paola, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Marton Ribary, and Barbara McGillivray (2025). “Le Journal of Open Humanities Data (JOHD): enjeux et défis dans la publication de data papers pour les sciences humaines”. In: *Humanités numériques et science ouverte. Vol III: Publier, partager, réutiliser les données de la recherche: les data papers et leurs enjeux*. Ed. by Joachim Schopf and Christine Kosmopoulos. Lille: Presses Universitaires du Septentrion.

Peer-reviewed articles

- 1 Westerling, Kalle, Kaspar Beelen, Tim Hobson, Katherine McDonough, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Daniel C.S. Wilson, and Ruth Ahnert (2025). “LwMDB: Open Metadata for Digitised Historical Newspapers from the British Library’s Collections”. In: *Journal of Open Humanities Data* 11 (1), pp. 1–32. DOI: 10.5334/johd.304.
- 2 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** (2024). “Mapping ‘when’-clauses in Latin American and Caribbean languages: an experiment in subtoken-based typology”. In: *Proceedings of the 4th Workshop on Natural Language Processing for Indigenous Languages of the Americas (AmericasNLP 2024)*. Ed. by Manuel Mager, Abteen Ebrahimi, Shruti Rijhwani, Arturo Oncevay, Luis Chiruzzo, Robert Pugh, and Katharina von der Wense. Mexico City, Mexico: Association for Computational Linguistics, pp. 24–33. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2024.americasnlp-1.4.
- 3 Ridge, Mia, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Miguel Vieira, Arianna Ciula, and Barbara McGillivray (2024). “Language of Mechanisation crowdsourcing datasets from the Living with Machines project”. In: *Journal of Open Humanities Data* 10 (1), pp. 1–9. DOI: 10.5334/johd.195.
- 4 Stopponi, Silvia, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Saskia Peels-Matthey, Barbara McGillivray, and Malvina Nissim (2024). “Natural language processing for Ancient Greek: Design, advantages and challenges of language models”. In: *Diachronica*. DOI: 10.1075/dia.23013.sto.
- 5 Haug, Dag and **Nilo Pedrazzini** (2023). “The semantic map of *when* and its typological parallels”. In: *Frontiers in Communication* 8. DOI: 10.3389/fcomm.2023.1163431.
- 6 Stopponi, Silvia, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Saskia Peels, Barbara McGillivray, and Malvina Nissim (2023). “Evaluation of Distributional Semantic Models of Ancient Greek: Preliminary Results and a Road Map for Future Work”. In: *Proceedings of the Ancient Language Processing Workshop associated with RANLP-2023*, pp. 49–58. URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2023.alp-1.6>.
- 7 McGillivray, Barbara, Paola Marongiu, **Nilo Pedrazzini**, Mandy Wigdorowitz, and Eleonora Zordan (2022). “Deep Impact: A study on the impact of data papers and datasets in the Humanities and Social Sciences”. In: *Publications* 10.4 (39). DOI: 10.3390/publications10040039.
- 8 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** (2022). “One question, different annotation depths: A case study in Early Slavic”. In: *Journal of Historical Syntax* (Special issue: “Annotating Historical Corpora”) 6.7, pp. 1–40. DOI: 10.18148/hs/2022.v6i4-11.96.
- 9 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** and Barbara McGillivray (2022). “Machines in the media: semantic change in the lexical field of mechanization in 19th-century British newspapers”. In: *Proceedings of the 2nd International Workshop on Natural Language Processing for Digital Humanities (NLP4DH)*. Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), pp. 85–95. URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2022.nlp4dh-1.12>.
- 10 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** and Hanne Martine Eckhoff (2021). “OldSlavNet: A scalable Early Slavic dependency parser trained on modern language data”. In: *Software Impacts*, p. 100063. DOI: 10.1016/j.simpa.2021.100063.

- 11 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** (2020). "Exploiting Cross-Dialectal Gold Syntax for Low-Resource Historical Languages: Towards a Generic Parser for Pre-Modern Slavic". en. In: *Proceedings of the Workshop on Computational Humanities Research (CHR 2020)*. Ed. by Folgert Karsdorp, Barbara McGillivray, Adina Nerghes, and Melvin Wevers. Vol. 2723. Amsterdam, Netherlands: CEUR Workshop Proceedings, pp. 237–247.  URL: <http://ceur-ws.org/Vol-2723/short48.pdf>.

Theses

- 1 **Pedrazzini, Nilo** (2023). "A quantitative and typological study of Early Slavic participle clauses and their competition". PhD thesis. University of Oxford.  URL: <https://ora.ox.ac.uk/objects/uuid:27636bb4-efd0-47bf-8e28-dce5a2b2ca4d>.

Presentations

Invited lectures and talks

- 1 "No one size fits all: Corpus design and annotation strategies for historical linguistic analysis" (Dec. 2025). La documentació medieval (segles IX-XII). Creació, bases de dades i gestió informàtica. Institut d'Estudis Catalans (Barcelona, Spain).
- 2 "LwMDB: Open Metadata for Digitised Historical Newspapers from the British Library's Collections" (Sept. 2025). A Decade of Open Humanities Data (Journal of Open Humanities Data's 10th Anniversary) (online).
- 3 "In other words: Notes on modelling language variation and history quantitatively" (July 2025). DSTI School of Engineering, Sophia Antipolis (Nice, France).
- 4 (Dec. 2024). Guest lecture (with Daniel CS Wilson and organized by Katie McDonough) about working with massive and noisy digital texts at scale, Lancaster University.
- 5 "T*xt as data: A (very small) sampler of (very cool) research projects in computational text analysis" (May 2024). Digital and Information Skills Community of Practice, Bodleian Libraries (University of Oxford).
- 6 "Language typologies using parallel text data and geo-statistics" (Apr. 2024). Office for Statistics Regulation (UK Statistics Authority; UKSA, London).
- 7 "T*xt as data: A sneak peek into the possibilities unleashed by computational methods" (May 2023). Creative & Heritage Innovation Challenge Workshop (Oxford, United Kingdom).
- 8 "Text mining per le Humanities: un'introduzione pratica con Python" (Mar. 2023). Hands-on introduction to text mining with Python for doctoral students at the University of Pavia (Italy).  URL: <https://github.com/npedrazzini/pavia-text-mining>.
- 9 "The Language of Mechanisation" (Nov. 2022). Presenting the Circle-U award-winning project at a round table at the Conference on interdisciplinary and transdisciplinary research for sustainable development (UCLouvain, Louvain-la-neuve, Belgium).  URL: <https://youtu.be/zx8HxMwOq4>.
- 10 "An introduction to Word2Vec" (July 2022). Digital Humanities at Oxford Summer School ("Text to Tech" strand), Oxford (United Kingdom).  URL: <https://github.com/Living-with-machines/dhoxss-text2tech>.

Conference presentations

- 1 "Disorder or (self-)murder? Making sense of suicide in 19th-century British newspapers" (Dec. 2025). Computational Humanities Research Conference (Luxembourg Centre for Contemporary and Digital History, University of Luxembourg), joint work with Daniel C.S. Wilson.
- 2 "SEAL: Sea Ice Forecasting using Active Learning" (Oct. 2025). 8th International Symposium on Arctic Research (ISAR-8). Authors: M.C. Novitasari, N. Pedrazzini, I. Fenton, J. Wilkinson, J.S. Hosking, and L. van Zeeland.
- 3 "Open Paleoslavica data sets and corpora as a catalyst for reproducible and extensible research" (Aug. 2025). XVIIth International Congress of Slavists. Panel: Paleoslavistics, the Digital Age, and the Future (Paris, France), joint work with Olga Lyashevskaya and Hanne Eckhoff.

- 4 “Early Slavic participle clauses and their typological parallels” (Aug. 2025). International Conference on Historical Linguistics (Santiago de Chile, Chile).
- 5 “Using AI forecast of satellite imagery to improve solar generation forecasts” (Apr. 2025). European Geosciences Union (EGU) Assembly, with James Fulton, Natalia Efremova, Nathan Simpson, Isabel Fenton, Evie Corcoran, James Robinson, Meghna Asthana, Peter Yatsyshin.
- 6 “GramTypix: a Python pipeline for subtoken-based language typology and probabilistic semantic mapping from parallel corpora” (Aug. 2024). Digital Humanities Conference (Arlington, Virginia).
- 7 “Mapping ‘when’-clauses in Latin American and Caribbean languages: an experiment in subtoken-based typology” (June 2024). Workshop on Natural Language Processing for Indigenous Languages of the Americas (AmericasNLP), co-located with the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL) conference (Mexico City).
- 8 “Temporal clauses in Old Church Slavonic and Ancient Greek: typological differences emerged from massively parallel corpora” (Aug. 2023). 56th Annual Meeting of the Societas Linguistica Europaea (SLE, Athens, Greece), joint work with Dag Haug. [URL: https://societaslinguistica.eu/sle2023/](https://societaslinguistica.eu/sle2023/).
- 9 “Metadata Enrichment in the Living with Machines Project: User-focused Collaborative Database Development in a Digital Humanities Context” (July 2023). ADHO Digital Humanities Conference (DH2023, Graz, Austria), joint work with Kalle Westerling, David Beavan, Kaspar Beelen, Mariona Coll Ardanuy, Timothy Hobson, Christina Last, Griffith Reese, and Like Hare. [URL: https://dh2023.adho.org](https://dh2023.adho.org).
- 10 “Diachronic and diatopic word embeddings from British historical newspapers” (June 2023). 12th AIUCD (Convegno dell’Associazione per l’Informatica Umanistica e la Cultura Digitale), joint work with Barbara McGillivray. [URL: http://www.aiucd2023.unisi.it](http://www.aiucd2023.unisi.it).
- 11 “Machines in the media: semantic change in the lexicon of mechanization in 19th-century British newspapers” (Nov. 2022). The 2nd International Workshop on Natural Language Processing for Digital Humanities – NLP4DH 2022 (AACL-colocated, Taipei, Taiwan), with Barbara McGillivray. [URL: https://rootroo.com/en/nlp4dh-2022/](https://rootroo.com/en/nlp4dh-2022/).
- 12 “Evaluating Language Models for Ancient Greek: Design, Challenges, and Future Directions” (Aug. 2022). International Conference on Historical Linguistics 2022 (ICHL25: Oxford), with Barbara McGillivray, Malvina Nissim, Saskia Peels-Matthey & Silvia Stopponi. [URL: https://ichl.ling-phil.ox.ac.uk/abstracts/168](https://ichl.ling-phil.ox.ac.uk/abstracts/168).
- 13 “Historic machines from ‘prams’ to ‘Parliament’: new avenues for collaborative linguistic research” (June 2022). DH Benelux 2022: RE-MIX. Creation and alteration in DH, with Mia Ridge, Giorgia Tolfo, Kalle Westerling and Barbara McGillivray. [URL: https://zenodo.org/record/6578021#.YtjqFy8w1Yh](https://zenodo.org/record/6578021#.YtjqFy8w1Yh).
- 14 “Deep impact: A study on the impact of data papers and datasets in the humanities and social sciences” (June 2022). SciDataCon (International Data Week, Seoul, 20-23 June 2022), with Marton Ribary, Mandy Wigdorowitz, Eleonora Zordan, Barbara McGillivray. [URL: https://www.scidatacon.org/IDW-2022/sessions/400/paper/975/#](https://www.scidatacon.org/IDW-2022/sessions/400/paper/975/#).
- 15 “Le Journal of Open Humanities Data (JOHD): enjeux et défis dans la publication de data papers pour les sciences humaines” (Nov. 2021). DHNord2021 round table “Le data paper: une nouvelle forme de publication scientifique en SHS”, with Paola Marongiu, Marton Ribary & Barbara McGillivray. [URL: https://meshs.fr/page/enjeux_et_defis_dans_la_publication_de_data_papers_pour_les_shs](https://meshs.fr/page/enjeux_et_defis_dans_la_publication_de_data_papers_pour_les_shs).
- 16 “Tackling lack of linguistic data with HTR: A specialized model for the transcription of Serbian Church Slavonic manuscripts” (Apr. 2021). El’ Manuscript Conference 2020. [URL: http://www.elmanuscript2020.uni-freiburg.de/wordpress/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/ElManuscript-2021-Booklet-of-Abstracts_09.04.2021.pdf](http://www.elmanuscript2020.uni-freiburg.de/wordpress/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/ElManuscript-2021-Booklet-of-Abstracts_09.04.2021.pdf).
- 17 “Same question, different annotation depths: early Slavonic dative absolute in deeply versus shallowly annotated treebanks” (Nov. 2020). Grammar & Corpora International Conference, Kraków (Poland) [held as online event]. [URL: https://gac2020.ijp.pan.pl/GaC_2020_paper_25.pdf](https://gac2020.ijp.pan.pl/GaC_2020_paper_25.pdf).
- 18 “Exploiting Cross-Dialectal Gold Syntax for Low-Resource Historical Languages: Towards a Generic Parser for Pre-Modern Slavic” (Nov. 2020). Computational Humanities Research Workshop, Amsterdam (The Netherlands).

- 19 “Participial free adjuncts in early Slavic treebanks: The discourse properties of the dative absolute” (Sept. 2020). Slavic Linguistics Society (SLS) Conference, Bloomington (IN, USA) [held as online event].  URL: <https://slavicgf.siteshost.iu.edu/SLS/abstracts/Pedrazzini.PDF>.
- 20 “Challenges in historical corpus analyses of discourse relations: a case study in Old Church Slavonic” (June 2020). Corpora & Discourse International Conference, University of Sussex (UK) [held as online event].

Other contributions

Blog posts

- 1 *Fairytales on trial: the Good and the Beautiful in early-Soviet children’s literature* (Mar. 2019). British Library, European Studies Blog.  URL: <https://blogs.bl.uk/european/2019/03/fairytales-on-trial.html>.
- 2 *A reluctantly modern voice from the 17th-century Russian storm: Archpriest Avvakum and the Life written by himself* (June 2015). British Library, European Studies Blog.  URL: <https://blogs.bl.uk/european/2015/06/a-reluctantly-modern-voice-from-the-17th-century-russian-storm.html>.

Media

- 1 *Living with Machines: On Collaboration*. Docuseries episode. (2023).  URL: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A__ZJgw4_00.
- 2 *Living with Machines: The Language of Mechanisation*. Docuseries episode. (2023).  URL: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qSciC6ymLK0>.